



INSTRUCTION MANUAL

Safire v1.1.0 · July 2026

Safire

A privacy-focused, local-first Markdown knowledge forge for notes, ideas, projects, daily logs, backlinks, tags, graph exploration, attachments, and recoverable edits.

[Local files](#)[Markdown vault](#)[Backups](#)[Historical guide](#)

What this manual covers

Installation and launch, the Safire workspace, writing notes, organizing a vault, links and graph view, attachments, backups, restore, settings, keyboard shortcuts, privacy, troubleshooting, and credits.

Historical guide · Safire 1.1.0 · Superseded by the current user guide



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1. Overview

Safire is a desktop knowledge workspace that stores your writing as normal `.md` Markdown files on your computer. It is designed to feel polished and app-like while keeping your information readable, portable, and under your control.

Local-first

Your notes live in a folder called a vault. They remain ordinary files that can be backed up, copied, searched, or opened outside Safire.

Connected thinking

Use `[[wikilinks]]`, backlinks, outgoing links, tags, and graph view to connect notes into a living knowledge map.

Writing flow

Use split view, preview view, edit view, tabs, autosave, command palette, quick switcher, and Markdown toolbar shortcuts.

Trust features

Safire creates backups before writes/deletes and includes a backup browser with preview and restore.

2. Quick Start

1 Launch Safire

Open the Safire desktop app. If you are using a developer/browser run, start the server from the project folder with `npm start` and open `http://127.0.0.1:5277`.

2 Choose or confirm your vault

Safire uses the vault selected during desktop setup. Developer/browser mode can set `SAFIRE_VAULT_PATH` explicitly.

3 Create your first note

Click **+ Note**, enter a name, and start typing. Safire automatically appends `.md` when needed.

4 Link ideas together

Type `[[Ideas]]` or use the **Wiki** toolbar button. Links appear in preview and can create missing notes.

5 Use commands

Press `Ctrl` + `K` for the command palette or `Ctrl` + `O` for the quick switcher.

Local service: Safire's application service binds to `127.0.0.1`, so it is intended to be reachable only from the same computer.

3. Workspace Tour

Area	Purpose
Ribbon	Compact vertical controls for files, search, graph, backups, settings, and command palette.
Sidebar	App identity/version, note/folder buttons, search box, vault path, file tree, and tag cloud.
Tabs	Keep multiple notes open and switch between them quickly.
Top bar	Shows active note title, save/autosave state, view mode buttons, attach, backups, settings, rename, save, and delete.
Editor	Write raw Markdown. In split mode it appears beside the rendered preview.
Preview	Rendered Markdown with clickable wikilinks and attachment links.
Inspector	Backlinks, outgoing links, properties, status, vault health, and shortcut reminders.

4. Creating & Editing Notes

Create a note

1. Click **+ Note**.
2. Enter a title or path, such as `Projects/Safire Ideas`.
3. Click **Create note**.

Rename or move a note

Click **Rename** and enter a new path. Including a folder path moves the note, for example `Projects/Ideas.md`.

Delete a note

Click **Delete**. Safire asks for confirmation and creates a backup copy before deletion.

Important: Although Safire creates backups, keep a separate backup of your vault folder using your normal PC backup method.

5. Markdown & Toolbar

Safire uses Markdown, a plain-text format that remains readable even outside the app. The toolbar helps insert common Markdown patterns.

Toolbar Button	Inserts	Use For
H1 / H2	# Heading , ## Heading	Document sections
B / I	**bold** , <i>*italic*</i>	Emphasis
`Code` / Block	<code>`inline code`</code> , fenced code blocks	Commands, snippets, technical notes
Quote	> quote	Quoted material or highlights
List / Task	- item , - [] task	Lists and checklists
Link	[text](https://...)	Web links or file links
Wiki	[[Note Name]]	Internal note links

6. Folders, Tags & Search

Folders

Click + **Folder** to create vault folders. Notes can be nested inside folders by naming them with a path.

Tags

Type tags directly in notes, such as #project , #daily , or #ideas . Safire collects tags into the sidebar tag cloud.

Search

Use the sidebar search box to search note names and note content. Clicking a result opens the note.

7. Wikilinks, Backlinks & Graph

Wikilinks connect notes by title. For example, typing `[[Project Plan]]` creates a clickable link to a note named `Project Plan.md`.

- **Outgoing links** show notes that the current note points to.
- **Backlinks** show notes that point back to the current note.
- **Graph view** shows a visual map of note relationships.

Tip: Use wikilinks liberally while writing. You can create missing notes later by clicking unresolved links in preview.

8. Attachments

Safire can copy files into the vault and insert Markdown links to them.

Add an attachment

1. Click **Attach** or **Attach file**, or drag/drop a file into the editor.
2. Safire copies the file into the vault's `Attachments/` folder.
3. A Markdown link is inserted into the note.

Open an attachment

Click the attachment link in preview. Safire opens the file in an in-app attachment viewer so the note app stays open. Use **Back to Safire**, the close button, or `Esc` to return to your note.

Image attachments

Images are inserted as Markdown image links and display in preview.

9. Daily Notes

Click **Today** to open or create a daily note under `Daily Notes/YYYY-MM-DD.md`. Daily notes are useful for logs, scratch notes, work journals, and lightweight task capture.

2026-07-06

Notes

Tasks

- []

#daily

10. Backups & Restore

Safire creates dated backup files before note saves and deletes. These backups are stored under `.safire-backups/` inside the vault.

Preview backups

1. Open a note.
2. Click **Backups**.
3. Select a backup from the list to preview its content.

Restore a backup

1. Select a backup.
2. Click **Restore this backup**.
3. Confirm. Safire creates a safety backup of the current note first, then restores the selected version.

11. Settings

Open **Settings** from the top bar or command palette. Settings are stored locally inside the vault.

Setting	Description
Autosave	Turn automatic save on or off.
Autosave delay	Controls how long Safire waits after edits before autosaving.
Startup note	The note Safire opens at launch.
Default view	Choose Split, Edit, Preview, or Graph as the default view.
Daily notes folder	Folder used for daily notes.
Backup retention days	Retention preference for future backup management.
Confirm deletes	Control whether deletion confirmation is required.

Keyboard Shortcuts

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl + K	Open command palette
Ctrl + O	Open quick switcher
Ctrl + S	Save active note
Esc	Close palette, switcher, dialogs, or attachment viewer

12. Privacy & Safety

- Safire stores notes as plain Markdown files in your chosen vault folder.
- The local API binds to `127.0.0.1` by default.
- File APIs reject path traversal outside the vault.
- Backups are created before writes/deletes.
- Safire is not a cloud sync service. If you need off-device backup, use a backup tool you trust.

13. Troubleshooting

Issue	Suggested Action
The app does not open	Try launching the app again. In developer mode, run <code>npm start</code> and confirm <code>http://127.0.0.1:5277</code> responds.
A note seems missing	Check the file tree, search by title/content, and inspect the vault folder directly.
A link creates the wrong note	Check spelling and capitalization of the wikilink target. Rename the note if needed.
Attachment does not preview	Use the Download file link in the attachment viewer and verify the file exists in <code>Attachments/</code> .
Need to recover old text	Open Backups , preview previous versions, and restore the correct one.
Preview looks stale	Save the note, refresh the app, or switch views. In browser/dev mode, a service worker cache may need a cache-busting reload.

14. Credits

Application: Safire v1.1.0, a local-first Markdown knowledge forge.

Status: Historical documentation retained for version reference.

Core technologies: React, Vite, TypeScript, Express, Electron, electron-builder, and marked.

Branding: Safire name, flame visual identity, and local knowledge-forge concept prepared for this original application.

Privacy note: Safire is designed around local Markdown files and local-only operation. It is not affiliated with Obsidian or any other proprietary notes product and does not copy proprietary code, assets, branding, names, or implementation.

Manual: Safire Instruction Manual v1.1.0, prepared July 2026.

Safire stores your work in normal Markdown files. Keep backups of your vault. This manual describes Safire v1.1.0; future versions may add, remove, or rename features.